

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

year with a surplus in your expense account and the company allows you to keep it, then use that as the Lord leads you both.

QUESTION 13. Should we wait to have children until we can afford them?

Raising children seems very expensive. Should we wait before we decide to have children?

ANSWER: First, let me say I'm not a family counselor, but I believe that children, like everything else in your lives, need to be planned, within reason. I'm not going to attempt to tell anyone how many children they should have, or when. Obviously, that's between you and God. But you need to think it out very thoroughly and seek His wisdom.

I recommend that young couples do not budget the wife's money into their month-by-month spending. Even if you're not planning to have children immediately, I would recommend that the wife's income be saved and used for one-time purchases such as a down payment on a home, buying a car, or a vacation. That way, even if it is eliminated, you can survive financially without it.

QUESTION 14. Should my wife work until my salary increases?

We have qualified for a home, based on both our salaries. My wife intends to work until my salary is adequate to meet the monthly payments. Is this acceptable?

ANSWER: I would advise you not to buy a home based on two incomes, ever. When you presume your wife will work until your salary increases to meet your needs, that's a dangerous presumption.

It would be better to rent what you can afford forever than to take on the pressures of a house payment that determines if, and when, you can have children. You can easily get trapped into a lifestyle that has no room for children if you're not